

After long delay, pot lounges get the go-ahead

Cannabis commission clears way for social use

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Marijuana lounges are officially coming to Massachusetts after a state board's approval Thursday, a milestone that could usher cannabis consumption further into mainstream society in upcoming years.

The Cannabis Control Commission's unanimous vote will establish new social consumption licenses, paving the way for the first regulated cannabis cafes — and weed-infused yoga classes and weddings and similar events — in New England. The proposed establishments have drawn concerns from critics about a feared increase in impaired driving, risks to workers' health, and the possibility that use of the once-illegal drug will become too widespread. But commissioners said they prioritized safety while following the wishes of voters, who legalized recreational marijuana and on-site consumption in 2016.

Thursday was “a monumental day,” commissioner Kimberly Roy said.

Massachusetts will join 12 states that allow businesses to host some level of on-site pot consumption, including Alaska, California, New Jersey, and Illinois.

“This is a huge step in normalizing cannabis,

MARIJUANA, Page A6

Estranged from father, Walshe allegedly tried to drain his estate

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

By the end of 2018, accused murderer Brian Walshe's life was beginning to unravel. His father had died that September. In October, federal prosecutors accused him of foisting a pair of sham Andy Warhol paintings on an unsuspecting art dealer — charges that could land him in prison.

But amid all that tumult, Walshe managed in December to convince the Plymouth County Probate Court to name him personal representative for his late father's estate — despite the fact his father had expressly disinherited him.

Thomas Walshe, a prominent neurologist, had been estranged from his son for years when he died unexpectedly while traveling in India that year.

According to a copy of his will that was later accepted by the court, Thomas Walshe acknowledged he had “only one child Brian Reza Walshe with whom I am not in contact.”

“If I do not herewith bequeath property in

WALSHE, Page A6

►Closing arguments today. B1.

For Trump and team, deny, deny

Noem forced to think twice on whether vets being deported

By Edward Fitzpatrick
GLOBE STAFF

Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem was engaged in the familiar routine of congressional hearings Thursday, basking in Republican praise and fending off attacks from Democrats over the administration's immigration tactics, when Rhode Island Representative Seth Magaziner broke up the traditional back and forth.

Magaziner, a Democrat on the House Committee on Homeland Security, began to grill Noem about whether her agency had deported US military veterans.

When Noem said none had been deported, Magaziner had a staff member come forward holding an iPad, where through video conferencing, the congressman introduced Sae Joon Park, a US Army combat veteran who he said had been deported after living in

the US for nearly 50 years.

Magaziner said Park was shot twice in Panama in 1989 and received the Purple Heart. He said Park suffered post-traumatic stress disorder and was arrested on “minor drug charges” in the 1990s.

Magaziner said Park has been sober for 14 years. But earlier this year, Magaziner said, the Trump administration deported him to South Korea, a country he has not lived in since he was 7 years old. Then the congressman asked Noem to join him in thanking Park for his service.

Noem said, “I am grateful for every person who has served our country and followed our laws.”

He followed up by asking Noem to explain to Park why she had him deported.

“This man took two bullets for our country,” Magaziner

VETERANS, Page A5



‘They don’t know how to tell the good guys from the bad guys.’

REP. SETH MAGAZINER, (above), speaking about Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem (top) and the Trump administration

By dismissing inflation despite clear evidence, he could be taking a risk

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Former President Joe Biden struggled with how to talk about high inflation, trying to downplay the problem while still conceding that some Americans were having trouble making ends meet.

President Trump has largely taken a different approach — deny there is any problem at all.

He has falsely claimed there is “no inflation” and called the broader issue of affordability “the greatest con job” and a Democratic “hoax.” Even the rare times Trump has acknowledged prices remain high despite his campaign promise to lower them on day one, he has blamed Biden. However, many economists say that it was Trump's own tariffs that have led inflation to accelerate this year.

“I have no higher priority than making America affordable again. That's what we're going to do,” Trump declared Tuesday night at a Pennsylvania rally, a day after saying he would give himself a grade of “A-plus-plus-plus-plus-plus” on his handling of the economy.

INFLATION, Page A5

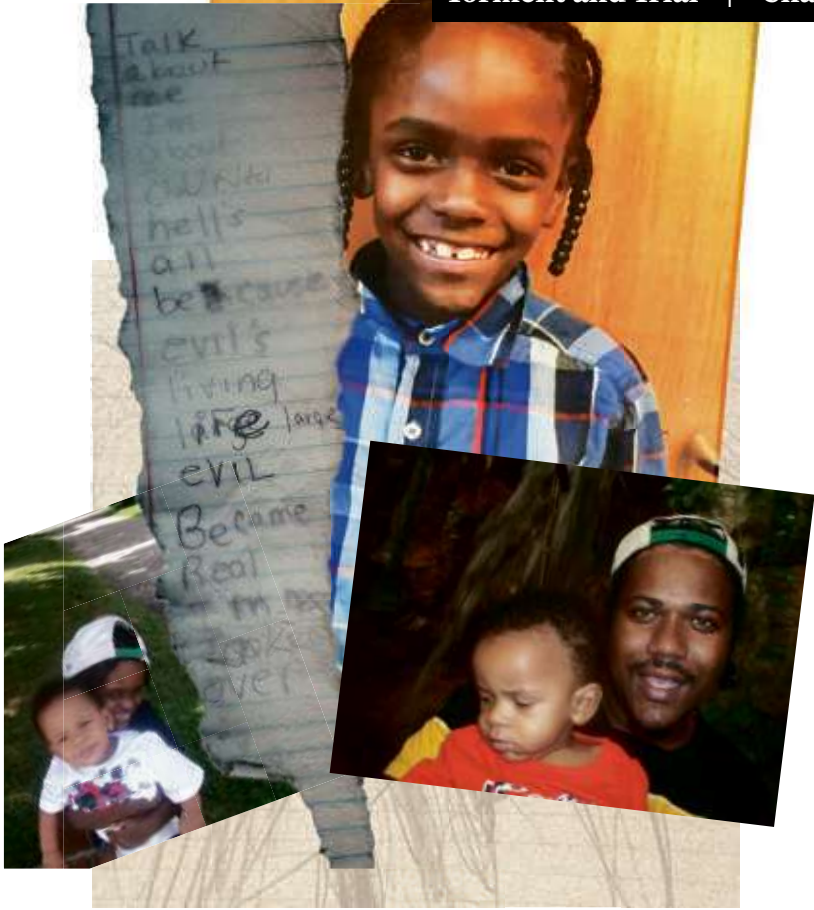
INUNDATED IN THE NORTHWEST



ERIKA SCHULTZ/SEATTLE TIMES VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

Days of torrential rain in Washington state have brought wide-scale flooding, and a state of emergency is now in effect. Tens of thousands of residents have been ordered to evacuate and some had to be rescued from their homes. Above, a house was surrounded by flood waters Thursday near Twin Rivers Snohomish County Park in Arlington. A4.

Torment and Trial | Chapter Six



PHOTOS FROM SHALEA SANDERS; PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY RYAN HUDDLE/GLOBE STAFF

Latarsha Sanders was convicted of first-degree murder for killing her children Marlon, 8, and La'son, 5, in 2018, even though she was experiencing severe symptoms of mental illness at the time. This series explores what led up to the horrific day when Sanders killed her sons, and how the justice system treated Sanders and her family afterward.

We ask too much of jurors in insanity cases. Especially ones as horrifying as this.

By Yvonne Abraham | Globe Columnist

The Verdict ■ By the time jurors began their deliberations around 12:20 on the afternoon of Dec. 27, 2022, they had sat through seven days of testimony.

Plymouth Assistant District Attorney Amanda Fowle had called to the stand two Brockton police officers, two state troopers, a firefighter, an EMT, a crime scene analyst, a videographer, a DNA expert, and two medical examiners. Their testimony, and dozens of graphic photographs, painted a vivid and sickening picture of what Latarsha Sanders had done almost five years earlier, killing her two youngest boys Marlon, 8, and La'son, 5, by stabbing each of them dozens of times.

Now jurors were asked to put aside their emotions to focus on just one thing: whether Sanders should be held criminally responsible.

It had taken two days to seat the jury. Many potential jurors told the judge they didn't think they could handle the evidence, or be impartial.

“I just don't know what kind of a monster does that,” said one, according to the trial transcript.

“I think insanity is used awful generously today,” said another. “Nobody takes responsibility.”

“If it's children, I'm going to be biased,” said another.

SANDERS, Page A7

The Senate deadlocked on competing proposals to avert rising health care premiums, blocking Democratic and GOP alternatives. A2.

Ukraine's president said a compromise peace plan still calls for a concession his country won't make. A3.

The holiday season is prime time for scammers. Sean P. Murphy has some steps you can take to protect yourself. The Fine Print, B5.

Take the wind

Friday: Sunny, still breezy. High 34-39. Low 24-29.
Saturday: Calming down. High 35-40. Low 25-30.
Weather and Comics, G6-7.

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